Conference or Training Request Approval Template
Attendance

Date 10/24/2026

Basic Information:

Agency: USDA

Program Area: Rural Development

Accounting Data: TBD — approval register

Project code: TBD — approval register

Event Name: RD Centralized Training (working title)

Event Date(s): 11/29/2026 thru 12/01/2026 Event Location: Chicago, IL (conditional)

Primary POC: TBD — approval register
Name, Phone, email

Secondary POC: TBD — approval register
Name, Phone, email

Estimated Expense Total: $32,969.66 + unquoted co

Select One: Conference ☐ Training ☑

If the event is training, is it considered Continuing Professional Education? CPE: PENDING Yes ☐ No ☐

Recurring Event: Yes ☐ No ☐ If yes, select ☐ Annual or ☐ Biennial ☐ RECURRING: PENDING

Provide actual expense information for previous year(s) participation in this event.

Annual TBD Biennial TBD

Narrative fields are limited to 8-10 lines of data using Times New Roman 10-pitch. Information beyond the visible field will not be viewed or printed

Event Purpose: (Narrative description of the Conference or Training objectives and expected outcomes.)

Purpose/outcomes: centralized training; curriculum and measurable outcomes are not provided and must be documented before approval (register). Travel is planned 11/28 – 12/2 to permit full attendance.

Was event included on the current year conference plan? Yes ☐ No ☐
PLAN STATUS: PENDING

If no, why was the event omitted ?

TBD: conference-plan status and omission rationale must be completed by the program owner (approval register).

How will the event help further the Agency's mission or the Department's strategic plan? (Narrative justification)

Potential relationship to RD mission requires the program owner to identify the specific RD authority, strategic objective, and expected operational benefit. No unsupported mission claim is made here.

The number of employees attending is appropriate to the purpose of the event and the mission of the agency. (Narrative justification)

24 is the conditional budget preference because the rule prioritizes more attendees. A role-based roster, workload need, and why 24 rather than 18 are necessary remain required.

The event is a "must-do" considering the limited budget of the agency. The information cannot be effectively shared through another means such as a teleconference, video conferencing, webinars, or other alternative media tools. (Narrative justification)

Remote alternatives have not been analyzed. Program owner/IT must document whether webinar, video, or hybrid delivery can meet the objectives and compare cost/effectiveness.

Federal funds will only be used for necessary and appropriate purposes and all conference expenses and activities will comply with the Federal Travel Regulation (FTR), the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR), the Agricultural Travel Regulation, and any other USDA requirements on lodging, food and beverages, per diem reimbursement, and contracting of goods and services.

Yes ☐ No ☐
COMPLIANCE: PENDING

Attendee Information:

Total Attendees: 24 (cond

Sponsoring Agency Attendees/Participants: 24 (cond

Other USDA Attendees/Participants: 0

Other Federal Attendees/Participants: 0

Non-Federal Attendees/Participants: 0

Will contributions be accepted from non-federal sources to defray the cost of attending the conference?

☐ Yes ☐ No
CONTRIBUTIONS: PENDING

If Yes, then how much will be accepted? TBD

If contributions will be accepted, has the acceptance decision been discussed with the Office of General Counsel? If yes, then ***please provide a copy of the OGC opinion.***

☐ Yes ☐ No
OGC: PENDING

Will your agency be hosting a booth (USDA or otherwise) at the event?

☐ Yes ☐ No
BOOTH: PENDING

Attachments:

1. ☐ Draft or previous year event agenda *(with specific information on how meals will be handled)*
AGENDA MISSING—REGISTER ITEM
2. ☑ Location Cost Estimate *(properly completed)*
3. ☑ Attendee Cost Detail spreadsheet *(excel soft copy version)*

Reportable (check all that apply):

☑ USDA OCFO [*over $7,000*]

☑ USDA OIG [*over $20,000]*

☐ HR933, Section 3003 [*over $100,000*]